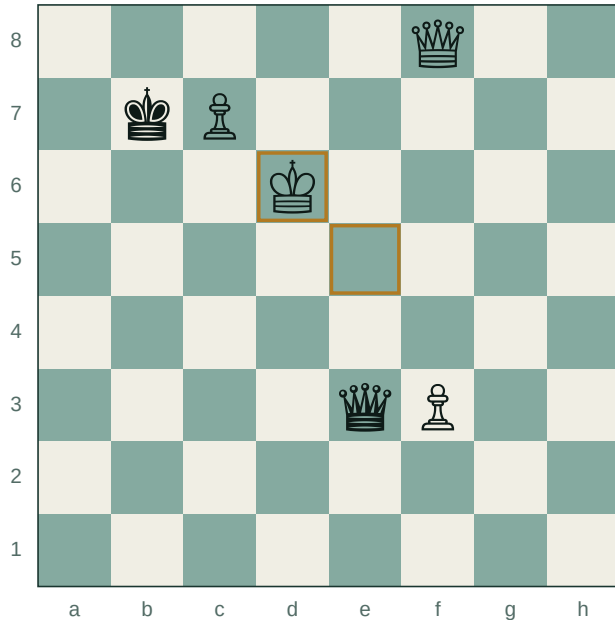


Queen-ending tactics: Black, move 60

Queen-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 60.Kd6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

60...Qa3+ 61. Ke5 Qxf8

60...Qa3+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **61.Ke5**.

61...Qxf8 The queen captures the queen on f8.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from -2 to +7. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on d6. Geometrically undefended: queen on f8. Check for tactical protection.